

UX IMPROVEMENT REPORT 002

Login Form – Email Field Retention Enhancement

REPORT OVERVIEW

- **Report ID:** UX-002
- **Module:** User Authentication – Login
- **Category:** Usability / UX Improvement
- **Priority:** MEDIUM
- **Impact Area:** User Experience & Efficiency
- **Status:** RECOMMENDED
- **Reported By:** Abdul Goni
- **Date:** December 29, 2025
- **Related Test Cases:**
 - TC-LOG-002 – Invalid password
 - TC-LOG-003 – Unregistered email
 - TC-LOG-005 – Empty password
 - TC-LOG-008 – Malformed email (server-side validation)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The login form currently clears **both email and password fields** after a failed authentication attempt. While this behavior is functionally correct and secure, it introduces unnecessary friction by forcing users to re-enter non-sensitive data that is usually already correct.

Recommendation:

Retain the email field value and clear only the password field after login failure.

Expected Outcome:

- Faster error recovery
- Reduced user frustration
- Alignment with industry UX standards

CURRENT SYSTEM BEHAVIOR

Functional Status: WORKING AS DESIGNED

The system correctly performs the following:

- Validates login credentials
- Displays error message: *"Incorrect email or password"*
- Keeps user on the login page
- Prevents unauthorized access
- Maintains application stability

There are **no functional defects** or system errors observed.

CURRENT USER FLOW (FAILED LOGIN)

1. User enters email (e.g. `john@example.com`)
2. User enters incorrect password
3. User clicks **SIGN IN**
4. Error message displayed
5. **Email field is cleared**
6. **Password field is cleared**
7. User must re-enter both fields
8. User retries login

UX ISSUES IDENTIFIED

1. Unnecessary Data Re-entry

- Email is commonly correct during failed attempts
- Clearing it adds avoidable typing effort
- Especially frustrating on mobile devices

2. Reduced Error Clarity

- Error message is generic
- Clearing the email prevents users from visually confirming which input was incorrect

3. Increased Cognitive Load

- Users must remember and retype known-correct data
- Slows down the login recovery process

4. Deviation from Industry Standards

Most major platforms retain email and clear only password:

- Gmail
- Facebook
- Amazon
- Twitter / X

AFFECTED SCENARIOS

- Wrong password entered
- Empty password submission
- Unregistered email
- Server-side email validation failure

All scenarios exhibit the **same clearing behavior**, regardless of which input is actually invalid.

PROPOSED IMPROVEMENT

Recommended Behavior (After Failed Login)

1. Error message displayed
2. **Email field retained**
3. **Password field cleared**
4. Cursor focus returns to password field
5. User can immediately retry password

Field Handling Recommendation

- **Email:** RETAIN (non-sensitive data)
- **Password:** CLEAR (security-sensitive data)
- **Focus:** Password field

BUSINESS & UX IMPACT

User Experience Benefits

- Faster retry flow

- Reduced frustration
- Clearer error recovery path

Estimated Impact

- Saves ~10–15 seconds per failed login attempt
- Reduces login abandonment risk
- Improves perceived product quality

Development Consideration

- Low implementation effort
- Non-breaking change
- Minimal risk

SUSPECTED ROOT CAUSE

- Global `form.reset()` triggered on all validation errors
- No selective field retention logic applied

RECOMMENDATION SUMMARY

1. Retain email field value after failed login
2. Clear password field only
3. Maintain current security behavior
4. Align UX with industry best practices

OUT OF SCOPE

- Changing authentication logic
- Modifying error message wording
- Backend security or validation rules

RELATED FINDINGS

- Similar UX issue identified in Registration flow (TC-REG-004)
- Indicates potential system-wide form handling pattern

This report documents a usability enhancement opportunity discovered during manual QA testing. The system functions correctly, but the proposed change improves efficiency, clarity, and user satisfaction without compromising security.